

AI Edge: AI Glossary Cheat Sheet

12 useful AI terms in plain English - signal, not acronym soup.

jonathan-harris.online/glossary/

Artificial intelligence (AI)

Software designed to perform tasks that normally require human judgement, pattern recognition or decision-making.

Machine learning (ML)

AI systems that learn patterns from data rather than relying only on hand-written rules.

Large language model (LLM)

A model trained on large amounts of text to predict and generate language.

Generative AI

AI that creates new text, images, audio, video or code from learned patterns.

Natural language processing (NLP)

Methods that help computers analyse, understand and generate human language.

Computer vision

AI techniques used to interpret images and video.

Predictive analytics

Using historical data and models to estimate what is likely to happen next.

AI agent

A system that can plan and take a sequence of actions towards a goal, often using tools.

Human in the loop

A workflow where a person reviews, approves or corrects important AI decisions.

Model drift

A decline in model performance when real-world data or behaviour changes after deployment.

Explainability

The ability to give people a useful account of why an AI system produced a result.

Algorithmic bias

Systematic unfairness caused by data, design choices, objectives or how a system is used.

Useful rule of thumb

Ask what data the system uses, what decision it influences, who checks it, and what happens when it is wrong.